What should we build for the activation review?

R17 is release 17 of a fictional product. It changed how customers import data. Growth wants to know why fewer accounts activated afterward. Sai has the account counts. What’s the smallest job you’d give an agent before Engineering decides whether to act?

What should you build first?

Checked ↑

Rare → Recurring

Use AI when needed

Rare question, answer checked on the same data.

Build here first

Recurring question, answer checked on the same data. Largest business impact.

Keep it exploratory

Rare question, answer unchecked or changing.

Fix definitions and checks first

Recurring question, answer unchecked or changing.

Unchecked ↓

Source: Paras Doshi, Agentic Analytics in Production: What to Build First, slide 3

Which job belongs in the top right?

Place three ideas on the build-first map: a recurring activation brief, a one-off segment table, and an agent that rolls back releases. How often does the question come up? Can you check the answer on the same data? Circle size shows business impact: the bigger the circle, the greater the impact. Pick one job; the decision belongs to Engineering, which keeps what stays in human hands.

Would you accept Engineering's premise?

Ask your agent, 'Prove the release caused the drop in activation.' Read its first sentence aloud. What would it need to know about who saw the new importer and who used the previous one before it could take a position?

Give two analysts the same job

Growth needs one number for Monday. Ask two clean chats for the active rate. If either silently picks a period or definition, ask Growth to specify both. Then recompute the counts.

Write down what ‘activated’ means

Activation means an eligible account completes its first intended action at least once within seven days. Count each account once, however many times it retries an import. Decide which of those events belong in the numerator.

Build your first semantic model

Give the agent one job before the release meeting: calculate seven-day activation from the four rows in data/activation.csv. Each row already contains counts for one period and segment. Add the activated counts and divide by the total eligible. Save the approved calculation and Product Data owner in work/model.json.

Try to break your definition

If no accounts were eligible, Product Data should approve a blank rate labeled 'no eligible accounts'. Run the model check. Zero successes among eligible accounts says nothing about how many tried, so a 0% must never stand in for the no-eligible case. Correct the expression before publishing.

What do you trust an agent to do here?

Think of an agent as a new grad with infinite energy who wants to please you. Give it the approved account definition, ask it to challenge your explanation, and require a second analyst to reproduce its count. For this first build, what evidence would make you send the brief back?